

TIMELINE

- January 3, 1901** Born into the influential Ngo Catholic clan in Quang Binh province, Annam (central Vietnam).
- 1918** Enrolls at the prestigious School of Public Administration and Law in Hanoi.
- 1921** Becomes a mandarin in the imperial administration of Annam.
- 1933** Appointed interior minister in Emperor Bao Dai's government. Resigns after three months when his proposals for reforms are rejected.
- 1943** Forms a clandestine political party associated with exiled Prince Cuong De.
- 1946** Refuses to join the Viet Minh after discussion with Ho Chi Minh.
- 1949** Offered the position of prime minister of the State of Vietnam by Bao Dai, but declines.
- 1950** Goes into exile after the Viet Minh threaten to assassinate him; lobbies for support in the US and Europe.
- 1954** Returns from exile and is appointed prime minister under Bo Dai; his brother Ngo Dinh Nhu founds the Can Lao Party to support him.
- October 1955** Declares himself President of the Republic of South Vietnam after winning a referendum rigged by the Can Lao Party.
- May 1957** Visits the United States, where he addresses Congress.
- November 1960** Survives an attempted coup by South Vietnamese army officers.
- February 1962** Survives the bombing of the presidential palace.
- May–August 1963** Faces the Buddhist Crisis, which discredits his rule.
- November 1, 1963** Overthrown in a US-authorized military coup.
- November 2, 1963** Brutally assassinated, along with Ngo Dinh Nhu.